The 20-Customer Persona Scorecard

Most personas get written in a meeting, from memory. This one comes from the people who already paid.

Step 1. List your 20 best customers and fill in each trait

Best by revenue, retention and how easy they are to serve. Fewer than 20? Use them all. Use bands, not labels: "11 to 50 staff", not "small".

#	CUSTOMER	HEADCOUNT BAND	REVENUE BAND	INDUSTRY	GEOGRAPHY	ROLE THAT SAID YES
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						
7						
8						
9						
10						
11						
12						
13						
14						
15						
16						
17						
18						
19						
20						
	Shared by 11 or more					

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Step 2. Keep only what more than half share

A trait goes into the persona only if 11 or more of your 20 share it. Everything else is noise.

PERSONA FIELD	WHAT SURVIVED
Headcount band	
Revenue band	
Industries (1 to 3)	
Geography	
Role and title variants	
The number they are judged on	
The objection that kills deals, word for word	
The trigger that makes it urgent	

Step 3. Write at least 3 exclusions

What do your worst five customers share? Those are the people to stop chasing.

#	WE DO NOT SELL TO
1	
2	
3	

The prompt that turns it into a persona

Build my buyer persona from my customers

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Build the buyer section of my Funnel Brief from the customer data below.
Fields: headcount band (a range), revenue band, 1 to 3 industries (in the words companies use about themselves), geography, roles with LinkedIn title variants, their goal (the number they are judged on, in their words), their challenge, where they get information (named publications, communities, people), buying process, the deal-killing objection word for word, the trigger, at least 3 exclusions, a ceiling client and a floor client.
A value goes in only if more than half of my best customers share it. Quote objections exactly. Mark anything you inferred as [check].
My best customers: [FILL: paste rows: company, size, industry, country, buyer title, why they bought]
Notes from sales calls: [FILL: paste notes or transcripts]
My worst customers and what went wrong: [FILL]
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The question to ask of every new lead: does this look like my best customers?

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